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General Knowledge
Modern History

STUDY NOTES

Political Associations Before INC

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Political Organisations Before Indian National Congress(INC)

- As British control spread across India, a strong sense of resentment emerged among the people. While peasants, tribals, and workers responded with uprisings and revolts, the middle class adopted a different strategy.
- They expressed their discontent by writing books, articles, and newspapers to critically examine British policies and raise public awareness. Additionally, they formed organizations, associations, and societies to coordinate efforts and promote collective activities. Their main approach was to protest British policies through petitions and resolutions, seeking to mobilize the masses through public meetings and statements.
- The Bengal, Bombay, and Madras presidencies, being the primary centers of British administration in India, were also hubs for education, middle-class intellectual growth, and political activity, making them natural focal points for early political organizations.

Political Organisations in Bengal	Details
Bangabhasha Prakasika Sabha	• Bangabhasha Prakasika Sabha was **founded in 1836** by the associates of **Raja Rammohan Roy**. • It came into being before the existence of the Indian National Congress (INC). • It worked for **administrative reforms, the association of Indians with the administration, and**

	spread of education and helped in arousing general will and laying down a path towards modern nationalism among the masses.
Landholders' Society	• **Year**: 1837 • **Founder**: Dwarkanath Tagore • **Place**: Kolkata • **Members**: Radhakant Deb, Prasanna Kumar Tagore, Rajkamal Sen, Bhabani Charan Mitra • **Objective**: Represented landholders of Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa, protecting class interests. Followed constitutional means to achieve goals. • **Spread**: Limited to Bengal Presidency. • **Suppression**: Became inactive around 1842, succeeded by Bengal British India Society.
Bengal British India Society	• **Founded**: 1843 • **Place**: Calcutta • It was formed by **William Adam**, a friend of Raja Ram Mohan Roy in 1843 in England. • **Objective**: Promoted good citizenship, public awareness on governance, and peaceful realization of goals within loyal bounds
British Indian Association	• **Founded**: October 1851 • **Place**: Calcutta • **Leadership**: President – Raja Radhakant Deb, Secretary – Debendranath Tagore • **Other Members**: Ramgopal Ghosh, Peary Chand Mitra, Krishnadas Pal • **Objective**: Sought improvements in local administration and government systems set by Parliament.

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Bengal Association	• **Founded**: 1852 • **Place**: Calcutta • **Objective**: Petitioned for an Indian legislative council, criticized exclusion of Indians from higher positions, and condemned European lavishness.
National Indian Association (NIA)	• **Founded**: 1870 • **Founder**: Mary Carpenter (with Keshub Chunder Sen) • **Objective**: Focused on promoting female education in India and facilitating interaction between Indians and British.
Indian League	• **Founded**: 1875 • **Founder**: Sisir Kumar Ghose • **Objective**: Represented middle class and masses, promoting nationalism.
Indian National Association	• **Founded**: 1876 • **Founder**: Surendranath Banerjee and Ananda Mohan Bose • **Objective**: Formed a public opinion, advocated Indian Civil Service reforms, repealed repressive acts. Merged with the Indian National Congress in 1886.

Political Organisations in Maharashtra	**Details**
London Indian Society	• **Founded**: 1865 • **Place**: London • **Founders**: Dadabhai Naoroji, W.C. Bannerjea,

	Manmohan Ghose, Pherozeshah Mehta, Badruddin Tyabji • **Objective**: Forum for Indian political grievances, with honorary European membership. Taken over by East India Association in 1866.
East India Association	• **Year**: 1866 • **Founder**: Dadabhai Naoroji, with Indians and retired British officials • **Place**: London • **Objective**: Platform for discussing Indian issues and representing India to the British government. • **Merger**: In 1949, merged with the National Indian Association to form the Britain, India, and Pakistan Association.
Poona Sarvajanik Sabha	• **Founded**: April 1870 • **Place**: Pune • **Founders**: G.V. Joshi, S.H. Sathe, S.H. Chiplonkar, Mahadev Govind Ranade • **Objective**: Acted as a mediator between the government and Indians, providing legal, agricultural, and famine relief services.
Bombay Presidency Association	• **Founded**: 1885 • **Founders**: Pherozshah Mehta, K.T. Telang, Badruddin Tyabji • **Objective**: Formed in response to reactionary policies and the Ilbert Bill controversy. Sent deputation to England with other associations in 1885.

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Political Organisations in Madras	Details
Madras Native Organization (MNA)	• **Founded**: 1852 • **Place**: Chennai • **Founder**: Gajula Lakshminarasu Chetty • **Objective**: Addressed grievances against Company rule, advocated for ryots' issues, and dissolved in 1867.
Madras Mahajan Sabha	• **Founded**: May 1884 • **Place**: Madras • **Founders**: M. Veeraraghavachariar, G. Subramania Iyer, P. Ananda Charlu • **Objective**: Aimed at freeing India from British rule, advocated for tax reductions, fundamental rights, and concurrent Civil Service exams.

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